

6.2a

Linking words and paragraph structure

Worksheet

- A** Linking words join one idea to another and help the reader to see how your argument is developing. Underline five linking words or phrases in this report extract about Kalia, an imaginary country.

Finally, the Kalian government is giving more control of economic policy to the regions. For instance, foreign companies do not need a license from the Industry Ministry. Moreover, these companies pay part of their taxes directly to the region where they are based rather than pay the whole amount to central government. On the whole this has made investing in Kalia much easier. However some problems, like the reform of agriculture, can only be dealt with at a national level.

Now complete the table with the words you underlined.

Showing a sequence	<i>First Secondly After that</i>
Talking generally	<i>In general Typically</i>
Making a contrast	<i>On the other hand Nevertheless</i>
Adding another point	<i>In addition to this</i>
Giving an example	<i>For example e.g.</i>

- B** Match each word or phrase from the left box with one from the right box.

*In fact i.e. As a result
In particular Obviously*

*Therefore Actually That is to say
Of course Above all*

Now complete the table by adding the ten words.

Giving real/true/surprising information	<i>As a matter of fact</i>
Saying something is obvious	<i>Clearly</i>
Giving the most important example	<i>Especially</i>
Rephrasing in a different way	<i>In other words</i>
Giving a result/consequence	<i>For this reason</i>

- C** Choose the correct words in this report extract. Look carefully at the whole context.

How to Cut the Time You Spend On Reports

Does information technology mean the end of paper in our offices? (1) *In fact/Moreover*, the amount of paper used in business is slowly going down, but not in all areas. (2) *For this reason/In particular*, the number of reports actually seems to keep growing. (3) *Clearly/Nevertheless* some reports are essential and need to be studied carefully, but (4) *above all/in general* reports are only read very quickly, and some are never read at all.

What can you do to reduce the amount you read and write? (5) *First/As a matter of fact*, see if each report is really needed. (6) *That is to say/However*, ask yourself 'If this report was destroyed in a fire tomorrow, what would be the result?'. The answer might surprise you. (7) *For example/Second*, keep your reports short and easy to understand. Can you use a graph instead of text? Is the writing clear and simple? (8) *Typically/Above all*, think of your readers: are you telling them more than they need to know? One suggestion is only to circulate the summary and recommendations. Your readers may miss some of the details, but (9) *especially/on the other hand* if they want the full report they can ask for it.

(10) *In conclusion/Nevertheless*, it is possible to save time on reports, but it may mean there is less information in circulation.